

Preferred Products for Medicare Advantage



In accordance with the CMS memo released in 2018, the use of preferred products is a recognized utilization management tool outlined in section 1852 of the Social Security Act that will help achieve the goal of lower drug prices while maintaining access to covered services and drugs.¹

Coverage for preferred products is applicable to FDA labeled indications when it is determined to be medically necessary, in accordance with CMS guidelines. Certain drugs may require prior authorization to ensure safe and effective use, consistent with Medicare rules defined in CMS National Coverage Determination (NCDs), relevant Local Coverage Determination (LCD) and Local Coverage Article (LCA) guidelines. Preferred products are subject to change based on new product launches, product approvals, drug withdrawals and other market changes.

Highmark's Medicare Advantage products have preferred products for the following categories:

Bone Resorption			
Preferred		Non-Preferred	
Oral/IV Bisphosphonates		J0897	Prolia (denosumab)
		J0897	Xgeva (denosumab)
		J3111	Evenity (romosozumab-aqqg)
Chronic Inflammatory Demyelinating Polyneuropathy (CIDP)			
Preferred		Non-Preferred	
Systemic corticosteroids		J9334	Vyvgart Hytrulo (efgartigimod alfa and hyaluronidase-qvfc)
Immune globulin therapy			
Chronic Rhinosinusitis with Nasal Polyps (CRSwNP) ⁴			
Preferred		Non-Preferred	
J2182	Nucala (mepolizumab)	J2356	Tezspire (tezepelumab-ekko)
J2357	Xolair (omalizumab)		
NOC	Dupixent (dupilumab)		
Eculizumab Biosimilars			
Preferred		Non-Preferred	
J1299	Soliris (eculizumab)	Q5151	Epysqli (eculizumab-aagh)
		Q5152	Bkemv (eculizumab-aeeb)
Generalized Myasthenia Gravis			
Preferred		Non-Preferred	
J9332	Vyvgart (efgartigimod alfa-fcab)	J1303	Imaavy (nipocalimab-aahu)

	J9334	Vyvgart Hytrulo (efgartigimod alfa and hyaluronidase-qvfc)	J9333	Rystiggo (rozanolixizumab-noli)
	J1299	Soliris (eculizumab)	Q5151	Epysqli (eculizumab-aagh)
	J1303	Ultomiris (ravulizumab-cwvz)	Q5152	Bkemv (eculizumab-aeeb)
			J1823	Uplizna (inebilizumab-cdon)
	Golimumab Biosimilars			
	Preferred		Non-Preferred	
	J1602 NOC	Simponi, Simponi Aria (golimumab)	NOC	Immgolis, Immgolisi Intri (golimumab-sldi)
	Hypercholesterolemia³			
	Preferred		Non-Preferred	
	Proprotein convertase subtilisin kexin 9 (PCSK9) inhibitors		J1305	Evkeeza (evinacumab-dgnb)
			J1306	Leqvio (inclisiran)
	Intra-Articular Hyaluronan Injections			
	Preferred		Non-Preferred	
	J7323	Euflexxa (1% sodium hyaluronate)	J7326	Gel-One (cross-linked hyaluronate)
	J7318	Durolane (hyaluronic acid)	J7320	GenVisc 850 (sodium hyaluronate)
	J7321	Supartz (sodium hyaluronate)	J7321	Hyalgan (sodium hyaluronate)
	J7328	GelSyn-3 (hyaluronic acid)	J7322	Hymovis (high molecular weight viscoelastic hyaluronan)
			J7327	Monovis (lightly cross-linked high molecular weight hyaluronic acid)
			J7324	Othovisc (high molecular weight hyaluronan)
			J7325	Synvisc/Synvisc-One (hylan G-F 20)
			J7331	Synjoynnt (1% sodium hyaluronate)
			J7332	Triluron (sodium hyaluronate)
			J7329	TriVisc (sodium hyaluronate)
			J7321	Visco-3 (sodium hyaluronate)
	Intravitreal Injections for wAMD³			
	Preferred		Non-Preferred	

	J9035	Avastin (bevacizumab)	J0178	Eylea, Eylea HD (aflibercept)
	C9257		J0177	
	Q5107	Mvasi (bevacizumab-awwb)	J2778	Lucetnis (ranibizumab)
	Q5118	Zirabev (bevacizumab-bvzr)	J0179	Beovu (brolucizumab-dbli)
			Q5124	Byooviz (ranbizumab-nuna)
			J2779	Susvimo (ranibizumab ocular implant)
			J2777	Vabysmo (faricimab-svoa)
			Q5128	Cimerli (ranbizumab-eqrn)
			Q5147	Pavblu (aflibercept-ayyh)
			Q5149	Enzeevu (aflibercept-abzv)
			Q5170	Eydenzelt (aflibercept-boav)
			Q5155	Yesafili (aflibercept-jbvf)
			Q5150	Ahzantive (aflibercept-mrbb)
			Q5153	Opuviz (aflibercept-yszy)
			Q5168	Nufymco (ranibizumab-leyk)
	Infliximab Biosimilars			
	Preferred		Non-Preferred	
	Q5121	Avsola (infliximab-axxq)	J1745	Remicade (infliximab)
	Q5103	Inflectra (infliximab-dyyb)	J1745	Unbranded infliximab
			Q5104	Renflexis (infliximab-abda)
	Omalizumab Biosimilars			
	Preferred		Non-Preferred	
	J2357	Xolair (omalizumab)	Q5154	Omlyclo (omalizumab-igec)
	Pulmonary Hypertension			
	Preferred		Non-Preferred	
	Generic treprostinil		J3285	Remodulin (treprostinil)
	Repository Corticotropin			
	Preferred		Non-Preferred	
	Oral/IV Corticosteroids		J0801 J0802	H.P. Acthar (repository corticotropin)

	Interleukin-5 Antagonists for Severe Eosinophilic or Allergic Asthma ⁴			
	Preferred		Non-Preferred	
	J0517	Fasenra (benralizumab)	J2786	Cinqair (reslizumab)
	J2182	Nucala (mepolizumab)	J2361	Exdensus (depemokimab)
	Severe Eosinophilic or Allergic Asthma ⁴			
	Preferred		Non-Preferred	
	J0517	Fasenra (benralizumab)	J2356	Tezspire (tezepelumab-ekko)
	J2182	Nucala (mepolizumab)		
	J2357	Xolair (omalizumab)		
	NOC	Dupixent (dupilumab)		
	Ustekinumab Biosimilars			
	Preferred		Non-Preferred	
	Q5100	Yesintek (ustekinumab-kfce)	Q5098	Imuldosa (ustekinumab-srlf)
			Q9999	Otulfi (ustekinumab-aauz)
			Q9996 Q9997	Pyzchiva (ustekinumab-ttwe)
			Q9998	Selarsdi (ustekinumab-aekn)
			Q5099	Steqeyma (ustekinumab-stba)
Q5164			Starjemza (ustekinumab-hmny)	
Q5137 Q5138			Wezlana (ustekinumab-auub)	
J3357 J3358			Stelara (ustekinumab)	
Oncology Plan Preferred Products				
Bevacizumab Products				
Preferred		Non-Preferred		
Q5107	Mvasi (bevacizumab-awwb)	J9035	Avastin (bevacizumab)	
Q5118	Zirabev (bevacizumab-bvzr)	Q5126	Alymsys (bevacizumab-maly)	
		Q5129	Vegzelma (bevacizumab-adcd)	
		Q5160	Jobevne (bevacizumab-nwgd)	

	NOC				Avzivi (bevacizumab-tnjn)	
	Rituximab Products					
	Preferred			Non-Preferred		
	Q5115	Truxima (rituximab-abbs)		J9312	Rituxan (rituximab)	
	Q5119	Ruxience (rituximab-pvvr)		J9311	Rituxan Hycela (rituximab and hyaluronidase human)	
				Q5123	Riabni (Rituximab-arrx)	
	Trastuzumab Products					
	Preferred			Non-Preferred		
	Q5117	Kanjinti (trastuzumab-anns)		J9355	Herceptin (trastuzumab)	
	Q5116	Trazimera (trastuzumab-qyyp)		J9356	Herceptin Hylecta (trastuzumab and hyaluronidase-oysk)	
				Q5113	Herzuma (trastuzumab-pkrb)	
				Q5112	Ontruzant (trastuzumab-dttb)	
				Q5114	Ogivri (trastuzumab-dkst)	
				Q5146	Hercessi (trastuzumab-strf)	
	Oncology Supportive Care: Colony Stimulating Factors					
	Pegfilgrastim Products					
	Preferred			Non-Preferred		
	J2506	Neulasta, Neulasta Onpro (pegfilgrastim)		Q5111	Udenyca (pegfilgrastim-cbqv)	
	Q5108	Fulphila (pegfilgrastim-jmdb)		Q5122	Nyvepria (pegfilgrastim-apgf)	
				Q5127	Stimufend (pegfilgrastim-fpgk)	
				Q5130	Fylnetra (pegfilgrastim-pbbk)	
				Q5120	Ziextenzo (pegfilgrastim-bmez)	
				Q5169	Armlupeg (pegfilgrastim-unne)	
				NOC	Ennumo (pegfilgrastim-pccg)	
				J1449	Rolvedon (eflapegrastim-xnst)	
				J9361	Ryzneuta (efbemalenograstim alfa-vuxw)	
	Filgrastim Products					
	Preferred			Non-Preferred		

	Q5101	Zarxio (filgrastim-sndz)	J1442	Neupogen (filgrastim)
	Q5110	Nivestym (filgrastim-aafi)	Q5125	Releuko (filgrastim-ayow)
			Q1447	Granix (tbo-filgrastim)
			Q5148	Nypozi (filgrastim-txid)
			NOC	Filkri (filgrastim-laha)
	Oncology Supportive Care: Skeletal Related Events			
	Denosumab Products			
	Preferred		Non-Preferred	
	J0897	Xgeva (denosumab)	Q5136	Jubbonti (denosumab-bbdz)
			Q5157	Stoboclo (denosumab-bmwo)
			Q5158	Conexxence (denosumab-bnht)
			Q5166	Osvyrti (denosumab-desu)
			Q5159	Ospomyv (denosumab-dssb)
			Q5161	Bosaya (denosumab-kyqq)
			Q5171	Boncresa (denosumab-mobz)
			Q5162	Bildyos (denosumab-nxxp)
			Q5167	Enoby (denosumab-qbde)
			NOC	Ponlimsi (denosumab-adet)
	J0897	Prolia (denosumab)	Q5136	Wyost (denosumab-bbdz)
			Q5157	Osenvelt (denosumab-bmwo)
			Q5158	Bomyntra (denosumab-bnht)
			Q5166	Jubereq (denosumab-desu)
			Q5159	Xbyrk (denosumab-dssb)
			Q5161	Aukelso (denosumab-kyqq)
			Q5165	Oziltus (denosumab-mobz)
			Q5162	Bilprevda (denosumab-nxxp)
			Q5167	Xtrendo (denosumab-qbde)

²This document contains references to brand-name prescription drugs that are trademarks or registered trademarks of pharmaceutical manufacturers that are not affiliated with Highmark.

³ Adequate therapeutic trial defined as 3 months from first dose of therapy.

⁴ Adequate therapeutic trial defined as 4 months from first dose of therapy.

In order for a request for a non-preferred to be approved the individual must have had an adequate therapeutic trial and experienced a documented drug therapy failure or intolerance to the preferred products.

Adequate therapeutic trial is typically defined as six months from first dose of therapy at Food and Drug Administration (FDA) or compendia based therapeutic doses of preferred product. However, the trial period may vary based on therapeutic class and is noted in the above chart. New therapy is defined as no previous utilization within the last 365 calendar days.

These preferred products apply to professional providers and facility claims for all Highmark Medicare markets.

¹ Title XVIII of the Social Security Act, Section 1852(c)(1)(G), (c)(2)(B)